

Pad Thai (Variation 1)

Tags: pasta, thai, noodles, dinner, quick | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 15 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 750 g flat rice noodles (3–5 mm wide)
- 9 tbsp vegetable oil
- 900 g large prawns, peeled and deveined (or firm tofu, cubed)
- 12 garlic cloves, minced
- 6 shallots, thinly sliced
- 6 eggs, beaten
- Sauce: 9 tbsp fish sauce, 2 tbsp tamarind paste, 1 tbsp palm sugar or brown sugar, 1 tsp oyster sauce
- Toppings: bean sprouts, sliced spring onions, crushed roasted peanuts, lime wedges, dried chilli flakes, extra fish sauce

Method

1. Soak rice noodles in warm water for 30 minutes until pliable but not soft. Drain.
2. Whisk together sauce ingredients. Taste — it should be salty, sour, and slightly sweet.
3. Heat a wok or large skillet over very high heat until smoking. Add 2 tbsp oil.
4. Add prawns and cook 1 minute per side until pink. Remove and set aside.
5. Add remaining oil. Fry garlic and shallots for 30 seconds.
6. Add drained noodles and half the sauce. Toss for 1–2 minutes until noodles are coated.
7. Push noodles to one side. Add eggs to the empty side and scramble, then fold into noodles.
8. Return prawns, add remaining sauce, and toss everything for 1 minute.
9. Divide among plates. Top with bean sprouts, spring onions, peanuts, and lime wedges. Serve with condiments on the side.

Chef Tips

- High heat is essential — a home burner on maximum works; distribute by cooking in batches.
- Do not overcook the noodles during soaking or they'll turn mushy in the wok.
- Tamarind paste is the distinctive sour element — do not substitute lemon or lime juice.